

MIMAMSA (MĪMĀMSĀ)

VEDIC DUTY AND INJUNCTION → VALIDITY AND KNOWLEDGE SOURCES → POSTULATION AND NON-COGNITION → SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR → WORD AND SENTENCE MEANING → VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS AND GOD

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 VEDIC DUTY AND INJUNCTION

VEDIC DUTY AND INJUNCTION KNOWING WHAT OUGHT TO BE DONE VEDIC DUTY (DHARMA) IS KNOWN THROUGH INJUNCTION (CODANĀ), NOT IMPELLING FORCE (BHĀVANĀ) RITUAL ACTION UNSEEN RITUAL POTENCY (ĀPŪRVA) DELAYED RESULT CORE CLAIM

OBJECTIVE NORMATIVITY DOES NOT REQUIRE A DIVINE COMMANDER

MIMAMSA: KNOWING WHAT OUGHT TO BE DONE

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- MIMAMSA: KNOWING WHAT OUGHT TO BE DONE
- Vedic duty (dharma) is known through injunction (codanā), not perception prescriptive sentence → impelling force (bhāvanā) → ritual action

Vedic duty (dharma) is known through injunction (codanā), not perception prescriptive sentence → impelling force

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- unseen ritual potency (āpūrva) → delayed result core claim: objective normativity does not require a divine commander
- MIMAMSA: KNOWING WHAT OUGHT TO BE DONE

unseen ritual potency (āpūrva) → delayed result core claim: objective normativity does not require a

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Vedic duty (dharma) is known through injunction (codanā), not perception prescriptive sentence → impelling force (bhāvanā) → ritual action
- unseen ritual potency (āpūrva) → delayed result core claim: objective normativity does not require a divine commander

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: objective normativity does not require a divine commander.

01

STAGE 01 VALIDITY AND KNOWLEDGE SOURCES

VALIDITY AND KNOWLEDGE SOURCES INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAH-PRĀMĀNYA) COGNITION PRESENTS ITSELF AS TRUE UNLESS BHATTA ACCEPTS SIX SOURCES; PRABHAKARA DOES NOT TREAT NON-COGNITION NYAYA CONTRAST

EXTERNAL VALIDATION (PARATAH-PRĀMĀNYA) REGRESS PRESSURE SUPPORTS FIRST-TRUST, BUT CORRECTION

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAH-PRĀMĀNYA) cognition presents itself as true unless a later defeater establishes error	Nyaya contrast → external validation (paratah-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat	Bhatta accepts six sources; Prabhakara does not treat non-cognition independently
Bhatta accepts six sources; Prabhakara does not treat non-cognition independently	INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAH-PRĀMĀNYA) cognition presents itself as true unless a later defeater establishes error	Nyaya contrast → external validation (paratah-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE - INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAH-PRĀMĀNYA) cognition presents itself as true unless a later defeater establishes error - Bhatta accepts six sources; Prabhakara does not treat non-cognition independently	DECISIVE DISTINCTION - Nyaya contrast → external validation (paratah-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat - INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAH-PRĀMĀNYA) cognition presents itself as true unless a later defeater establishes error	EVALUATION / TRAP - Bhatta accepts six sources; Prabhakara does not treat non-cognition independently - Nyaya contrast → external validation (paratah-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyaya contrast → external validation (paratah-prāmānya) regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat.

02

STAGE 02 POSTULATION AND NON-COGNITION

POSTULATION AND NON-COGNITION POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI) EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS DEVADATTA IS STOUT + DOES NOT EAT BY DAY HE EATS AT NIGHT NON-COGNITION (ANUPALABDHI) KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE EMPTY FLOOR IS SEEN

POSTULATION IS NOT LOOSE GUESSING; NON-COGNITION IS NOT SIMPLE

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI): EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS	NON-COGNITION (ANUPALABDHI): KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE empty floor is seen under conditions in which the pot would	POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI): EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS
Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night	non-cognition is not simple inattention	Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE - POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI): EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS - Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night	DECISIVE DISTINCTION - NON-COGNITION (ANUPALABDHI): KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE empty floor is seen under conditions in which the pot would - non-cognition is not simple inattention	EVALUATION / TRAP - POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI): EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS - Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day → he eats at night

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE empty floor is seen under conditions in which the pot would have been seen trap: postulation is not loose guessing; non-cognition is not simple inattention.

03

STAGE 03 SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR

SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR THREEFOLD AWARENESS (TRIPUṬI-SAMVIT) ONE COGNITION DISCLOSES KNOWER, KNOWN AND KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) REVEALS THAT COGNITION OCCURRED ERROR NON-DISCRIMINATION THEORY VERSUS CONTRARY-COGNITION THEORY BOTH AVOID AN INFINITE

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PRABHAKARA: THREEFOLD AWARENESS (TRIPUṬI-SAMVIT) one cognition discloses knower, known and knowing together
- BHATTA: KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) REVEALS THAT COGNITION OCCURRED error → non-discrimination theory versus

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- contrary-cognition theory both avoid an infinite second-cognition regress by different strategies
- PRABHAKARA: THREEFOLD AWARENESS (TRIPUṬI-SAMVIT) one cognition discloses knower, known and knowing together

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- BHATTA: KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) REVEALS THAT COGNITION OCCURRED error → non-discrimination theory versus
- contrary-cognition theory both avoid an infinite second-cognition regress by different strategies

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BHATTA: KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) REVEALS THAT COGNITION OCCURRED error → non-discrimination theory versus contrary-cognition theory both avoid an infinite second-cognition regress by different strategies.

04

STAGE 04 WORD AND SENTENCE MEANING

WORD AND SENTENCE MEANING SENTENCE UNITY NEEDS EXPECTANCY + COMPATIBILITY + PROXIMITY DESIGNATION-THEN-CONNECTION WORDS FIRST DENOTE, THEN MEANINGS COMBINE CONNECTED-DESIGNATION WORDS DIRECTLY PRESENT MEANINGS ALREADY RELATED

VEDIC HERMENEUTICS RANKS INJUNCTION, EXPLANATORY PRAISE AND CONTEXTUAL INDICATORS

SENTENCE UNITY NEEDS EXPECTANCY + COMPATIBILITY + PROXIMITY designation-then-connection: words first

denote, then meanings combine connected-designation: words directly present meanings already related

Vedic hermeneutics ranks injunction, explanatory praise and contextual indicators semantic theory protects action-guiding scripture without

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SENTENCE UNITY NEEDS EXPECTANCY + COMPATIBILITY + PROXIMITY designation-then-connection: words first
- denote, then meanings combine connected-designation: words directly present meanings already related

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Vedic hermeneutics ranks injunction, explanatory praise and contextual indicators semantic theory protects action-guiding scripture without an original speaker
- SENTENCE UNITY NEEDS EXPECTANCY + COMPATIBILITY + PROXIMITY designation-then-connection: words first

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- denote, then meanings combine connected-designation: words directly present meanings already related
- Vedic hermeneutics ranks injunction, explanatory praise and contextual indicators semantic theory protects action-guiding scripture without an original speaker

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Vedic hermeneutics ranks injunction, explanatory praise and contextual indicators semantic theory protects action-guiding scripture without an original speaker.

05

STAGE 05 VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS AND GOD

VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS AND GOD VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (ĀPAURUSEYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE NYAYA GROUNDS SCRIPTURE IN A TRUSTWORTHY DIVINE SPEAKER; MIMAMSA GOD IS UNNECESSARY FOR VEDIC AUTHORITY, RITUAL EFFICACY OR

REMOVING AN AUTHOR SECURES AUTONOMY BUT COMPLICATES SEMANTIC INTENTION

VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (ĀPAURUSEYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE eternity of word supports an uncreated

Nyaya grounds scripture in a trustworthy divine speaker; Mimamsa does not

God is unnecessary for Vedic authority, ritual efficacy or karmic distribution

pressure: removing an author secures autonomy but complicates semantic intention

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (ĀPAURUSEYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE eternity of word supports an uncreated relation between word and meaning
- Nyaya grounds scripture in a trustworthy divine speaker; Mimamsa does not

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- God is unnecessary for Vedic authority, ritual efficacy or karmic distribution
- pressure: removing an author secures autonomy but complicates semantic intention

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (ĀPAURUSEYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE eternity of word supports an uncreated relation between word and meaning
- Nyaya grounds scripture in a trustworthy divine speaker; Mimamsa does not

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is unnecessary for Vedic authority, ritual efficacy or karmic distribution pressure: removing an author secures autonomy but complicates semantic intention.

06

STAGE 06 SELF, LIBERATION AND CRITICISM

SELF, LIBERATION AND CRITICISM ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH LIBERATION CESSATION OF EMBODIMENT, PAIN AND ACTION-PRODUCING CONDITIONS STRENGTH SOPHISTICATED EPISTEMOLOGY, SEMANTICS AND NON-THEISTIC NORMATIVITY LIMIT

RITUAL CENTRALITY AND UNSEEN POTENCY INVITE VERIFICATION OBJECTIONS REPLY DUTY IS KNOWN FROM THE VEDA BECAUSE ORDINARY SOURCES

conditions strength: sophisticated epistemology, semantics and non-theistic normativity limit: ritual centrality and unseen potency invite

objections reply: duty is known from the Veda because ordinary sources cannot disclose it

ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH liberation = cessation of embodiment, pain and

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH liberation = cessation of embodiment, pain and action-producing
- conditions strength: sophisticated epistemology, semantics and non-theistic normativity limit: ritual centrality and unseen potency invite verification

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- objections reply: duty is known from the Veda because ordinary sources cannot disclose it
- ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH liberation = cessation of embodiment, pain and action-producing

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- conditions strength: sophisticated epistemology, semantics and non-theistic normativity limit: ritual centrality and unseen potency invite verification
- objections reply: duty is known from the Veda because ordinary sources cannot disclose it

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ENDURING SELF SUPPORTS MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH liberation = cessation of embodiment, pain and action-producing conditions strength: sophisticated epistemology, semantics and non-theistic normativity limit: ritual centrality and unseen potency invite verification objections reply: duty is known from the Veda because ordinary sources cannot disclose it.

07

STAGE 07 PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS IDENTIFY BHATTA PRABHAKARA BEFORE WRITING STATE DOCTRINE GIVE CANONICAL EXAMPLE CONTRAST NYAYA ASSESS RESIDUAL ISSUE LINK INTRINSIC VALIDITY TO POSTULATION, NON-COGNITION

POWERFUL THEORY OF KNOWLEDGE AND DUTY, CONTESTED RITUAL METAPHYSICS

IDENTIFY BHATTA / PRABHAKARA BEFORE WRITING state doctrine → give canonical example → contrast Nyaya

assess residual issue link intrinsic validity to postulation, non-cognition and Vedic authority use exact terminology

after the English concept verdict: powerful theory of knowledge and duty, contested ritual metaphysics

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IDENTIFY BHATTA / PRABHAKARA BEFORE WRITING state doctrine → give canonical example → contrast Nyaya →
- assess residual issue link intrinsic validity to postulation, non-cognition and Vedic authority use exact terminology only

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- after the English concept verdict: powerful theory of knowledge and duty, contested ritual metaphysics
- IDENTIFY BHATTA / PRABHAKARA BEFORE WRITING state doctrine → give canonical example → contrast Nyaya →

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- assess residual issue link intrinsic validity to postulation, non-cognition and Vedic authority use exact terminology only
- after the English concept verdict: powerful theory of knowledge and duty, contested ritual metaphysics

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: powerful theory of knowledge and duty, contested ritual metaphysics.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — THE MIMAMSA PROJECT KNOWLEDGE IN THE SERVICE OF VEDIC DUTY (DHARMA) OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — INTRINSIC VALIDITY AND THE MEANS EXPLANATORY NECESSITY AND ABSENCE OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR TRIPUṬI, KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) AND TWO MIMAMSA THEORIES

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS	ADVANCED OBJECTION	COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Vedic duty (dharma) - OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — Intrinsic Validity and the Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) Architecture - OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — Postulation (arthāpatti) and Non-cognition (anupalabdhi): Explanatory Necessity and Absence - OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — Self-Awareness and Error: Tripuṭi, Knownness (jñātata) and Two Mimamsa Theories	- OPTIONAL DEPTH 5 — Word Meaning, Sentence Meaning and Ritual Hermeneutics - OPTIONAL DEPTH 6 — Authorless Veda, Anti-Theism, Action and moral consequence (karma) and Later Liberation (mokṣa) - OPTIONAL DEPTH 7 — Comparisons, Criticisms, Traps and the Contemporary Sanskrit Context - OPTIONAL DEPTH 8 — PYQ Routing, Answer Architecture and Complete Exam Deployment	- OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Vedic duty (dharma) Advanced normativity without divine command The school's unity lies in its governing problem. - Vedic duty (dharma) cannot be perceived, while ordinary inference cannot independently establish ritual obligation. - Vedic injunction therefore supplies normative knowledge, semantics explains sentence-unity, and unseen ritual potency (āpūrva) explains delayed efficacy.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.